

Cross-cutting Management and Plan (NWFPs)

Zhobleng Shingmen Tshogpa



Name of NWFP Group: Zhobleng Shingmen Tshogpa

Village: Zhobleng

Gewog: Nangkor

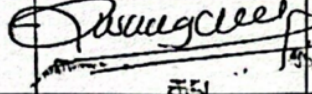
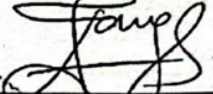
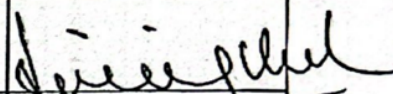
Dzongkhag: Zhemgang

Plan Period: September 2024 – September 2034 (*2nd revision*)

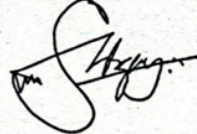
Approval sheet

Name of NWFP Management and Marketing Group	Zhobleng Shingmen Tshogpa
Village(s)	Zhobleng
Gewog	Nangkor
Dzongkhag/Dungkhag	Zhemgang
No. of households	10
Area (ha)	39.36
Plan period	September 2024 – September 2034

Prepared and submitted for Approval

	Chairperson of NWFP Management and Marketing Group	Gup of the Gewog	Head FRPMS of Division/Park	Chief Forestry Officer of Division/Park
Signature:				
Name:	Sangay Lhanden	Singye Wangchuk	Jangchu Wangdi	Tashi Wangchuk
Date:				

Reviewed and recommended for approval

	Reviewing Officer, FRPMD	Chief Forestry Officer, FRPMD
Signature		
Name	Kezang Wangmo	Sonam Tobgay
Date	07/10/2024	07/10/2024

Approved by:



(Director)

Department of Forests and Park Services, MoENR

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Acronyms

BDBL	Bhutan Development Bank Limited
DFO	Divisional Forest Office
hh	Household
ITMS	Institute of Traditional Medicine Services
Kg	Kilogram
Km	Kilometer
ac	Acre
ha	Hectare
SRF	State Reserved Forest
KNC	Khenrig Namsum Cooperatives
NWFP	Non-wood Forest Product
FRPMD	Forest Resources Planning and Management Division
FRPMS	Forest Resources Planning and Management Section

Part A: NWFP Management and Marketing Plan

1. Background

The Shobling village is located under Nangkor Gewog, Zhemgang Dzongkhag. It is one and half hour's drive from the Gewog Center at Buli. The community has access to basic amenities like electricity, water supply, motorable road and telecommunication network. Agriculture is primary source of livelihood in the village and people cultivate maize, rice, vegetables and cash crops like orange and cardamom. The community has formed a group and engages in marketing their vegetables. They also depend on forest for timber, firewood and Non-wood Forest Product (NWFP) for additional income generation.

The village has 10 households and they all are registered members of Shobling Shingmen Tshogpa. There are various types of NWFPs found in their locality. The group has selected *Piper mullesua* for management, which is abundant and preferred species in the market. There are 2 blocks identified as NWFP collection sites, collectively encompassing 39.39 hectares of SRF.

During the previous management plan period, the group collected and sold NWFPs for one season and rest of the seasons were inactive due to the pandemic. This is the 2nd reviewed management plan and the previous plan had expired in September, 2022. Before reviewing the management plan, a comprehensive consultation meeting with the management group members was conducted to understand the reason for shortcomings and to assess their interest in continuing further management. Having captured their interest in continued management of NWFPs, DFO Zhemgang provided technical support to the group in resource assessment and preparation of management plan. The management plan will guide the group members to implement the better management practices mainly on proper harvesting technique and other aspect of management.

2. Goal and objectives:

- To strengthen community institution to manage NWFP.
- To generate household income through sustainable harvesting of NWFP.

3. Description of NWFPs present in the area demarcated for management.

The NWFP management group will be managing two blocks for collection of Pipla, namely Pokchen and Dung-ngam. Dung-ngam block has an area of 28.46 ha. and Pokchen has 10.93 ha. The management area also has other NWFPs like *Zanthoxylum armatum*, *Emblica officinalis* and *Justicia adhatoda*. These NWFPs are not collected for commercial purposes due to less market opportunity, but often collected for self-consumption. The collection sites are located within a distance of 2 km from the village.

Pipla/Ragtang (*Piper mullesua*)

It is a perennial plant growing up to 1 to 2 meter in height and has a thick greenish leave. The plant has a unisexual reproduction unit with male and female plants and only few plants bear fruits. Pipla grows widely under the canopy of broadleaf forest or open area at an altitude range of 200-2200 masl. The plants thrive best in damp and moist soil with good shade. Its fruits start ripening in September.

Table 1. Brief description of NWFPs for commercial harvesting in each season

NWFP name	Harvesting area(s) (name)	Parts harvested	Use/purpose (traditional & others)	Harvesting season (months)	Estimated quantity for harvest in a season/year
Piper mullesua (Pipla/ Raktang_Kh)	Dung-ngam & Pokchen	Fruits	Spice/ medicine	September to November	500Kgs

4.Harvesting prescriptions for sustainable harvesting

The NWFP management group members have to adhere to specific procedure for the sustainable management of resources.

- a. The Chairperson will consult with forest office and obtain permit for collection during the onset of harvesting season.
- b. The Chairperson will announce starting date for harvesting only after obtaining required permits from forest office.
- c. Only one member from each household will be entitled for collection of NWFP products.
- d. Collection will be done within the demarcated area only.
- e. Harvesting prescriptions will be strictly followed by the collectors (Table 2).
- f. The Chairperson will maintain proper record of harvest and sale of NWFPs for monitoring and evaluation.
- g. Chairperson will notify the forest office on completion of harvesting the NWFPs.

Table 2. Prescriptions for sustainable harvesting of Piper mullesua

NWFP Species	Harvesting prescription
Piper mullesua (Pipla/ Ragtang_Kh)	• Collect fruits only when fully mature. • Harvest fruits only after the announced starting date for harvesting that are usually in September-November. • Harvest fruits only by hand picking without damaging, cutting or uprooting the entire plant.

5.Location sketch map of the NWFP harvesting areas

Sl.no	Location	NWFP	Area (Ha)	Distance from the center (Village)
1	Dung-Ngam Pokchen	<i>Piper mullesua</i> (Ragtang)	28.46 10.39	20 min 1hr



Figure 1. Location of NWFP Management area

6.Marketing and sales plan

Table 3. Marketing and sales plan

NWFP	Potential market	Estimated quantity for sale per season (unit)	Form of Products (dry/fresh)	Expected price/unit (Nu.)	Total (Nu.)
Pipla, (<i>Piper mullesua</i>)	Gelephu	500kgs	dry	150	75000

7.Marketing arrangement

The marketing arrangements for Non-Wood Forest Products (NWFP) involves following strategies to promote sustainable utilization of the resources.

Table 4. Procedures for NWFP harvesting, marketing and sharing of income

Activity	Brief description of how the activities is to carried out
Harvesting of products	• The Chairperson of NWFP group will obtain harvesting/collection permit from forest office in writing. • The Chairperson will announce starting date for harvesting only after obtaining required permits from forest office. • Only one member from each household will be collect NWFP for the first week and after that no limits is set for member involvement for collection. • Harvesting prescriptions will be strictly followed by the collectors.

	Chairperson shall inform Range Office of completion of harvest.
Postharvest practices	The collectors are responsible for post-processing of NWFPs.
Marketing of products	- The NWFPs will be handed over to the executive members for marketing after post-processing. - The executive members will sell the produce in attendance of the group members to maintain transparency. In future the group plans to construct a common sale counter at the center to facilitate marketing of the NWFPs products.
Identification of buyers	- The Chairperson supported by other executive members will monitor and explore the demand from nearby institutes, agents, companies and other business groups. - Support will also be sought from Department of Agriculture and Marketing Cooperatives (DAMC)
Price fixing	The executive members will coordinate.
Income sharing	- Nu.200 from each member household after sale of Pipla will be collected and deposited in the community development fund. - Sale proceeds of Pipla shall be paid to respective member household.
Raising of community development fund	- A joint account in the name of the group will be opened under BDBL Branch Office located at Buli. The account shall be managed by the committee members on behalf of the group. - Annual membership fees, contribution, penalties and certain amount of sale proceeds will be deposited in the community development fund.
Payment to committee members for their service	Not applicable

8.Benefit to the members

All the group members will have equal rights to sustainably harvest NWFPs from the area demarcated for management. In addition to sale proceeds of Pipla after deduction of amount to be contributed for community development fund, each member household shall be directly paid all the sale proceeds of Tsuth and Pagshi,

Table 5. Financial projection and benefits to the members from NWFP sales

Sl. No	Particulars	Products (names)	Total Amount (Nu)
		Pipla	
1	Revenues		
a	Total quantity (unit)	500kg	
b	Market price (Nu per unit)	150	
c	Total revenues from forest product sales (a*b)	75000	75000
A	Total revenues		75000
2	Expenses		
a	Packaging materials	-	-
b	Royalty	500kg @20 = 10000	10000
c	Transportation costs	3500	3500
d	Compensation fee to executive committee for marketing products	-	-

e	Contribution to community development fund	10hh @Nu.200 = 2000	2000
f	Incidental expenses	-	-
B	Total expenses		15500
C	Total benefit (net-income) of group members (Total revenues A – Total expenses B)		59500
D	Average income to group members (C/ no of group members)	5950	5950
E	Price per unit paid to group members (C/1a)	119	

9.Benefits to the group

Nu.200 per member household will be collected and deposited in the group joint account after marketing Pipla. The expenditures incurred in the name of management group shall be met from the community development fund.

Table 6. Financial projection of the benefits to the group, the community development fund

Sl. No	Particulars	Amount (Nu)
	Revenues	
1	Membership registration fees (10hh @100)	1000
2	Annual contribution	-
3	Contribution to the Community Development Fund (CDF) from sales of Pipla (10hh @Nu.200)	2000
A	Total revenues	3000
	Expenses (only include expenses that will be paid from the group funds)	-
		
B	Total Expenses	-
C	Balance: Total revenues – Total expenses	3000

Part B: Group Regulation and Norms (By-Law)

10. NWFP management & marketing group	
10.1 Membership arrangement and resignation 10.2. Responsibilities and rights of members:	Any household with census recorded in Shobling village and residing in the area can join the group. However, acceptance in the group will be made only by the group members through assembly. <u>Responsibilities and rights of members:</u> • Implement annual activities that are reflected in the management plan. • Manage the area in adherence to the management plan and refrain from doing illegal activities. • Attend ad-hoc/ planned meetings or activities for development of the group. • Attend any training related to NWFP. • Choose or reject committee members for better management of the group. <u>Procedure for becoming new members:</u> • Any household wishing to become members in the group shall submit application to the Chairperson. • The applicant should be 18 years of age to become a member. • The application shall be put forward in the general meeting for discussion and every member has right to accept or reject the application. • Membership fee of Nu.100/- shall be levied upon registration. <u>Procedure for leaving the group:</u> • Any member wishing to discontinue their membership has right to do so. However, he/she should submit application to the Chairperson. • He/she can leave the group after discussing with the committee members. • Member leaving the group will be allowed to draw 90% refund of memberships fees deposited by him/her without interest. • Further, the member leaving the group will not be allowed to avail their benefits from the group revolving fund. • If a member leaves the group without any valid reason, he/she is not entitled for any benefit from the group. • If their children wish to join as a member in future, they have to follow the procedure set to become new member.
11. Executive committee of NWFP management and marketing group	
11.1 Chairperson	Name of Chairperson: Sangay Lhaden Contact No. 77747565 <u>Responsibilities of Chairperson:</u> • Explore market for NWFPs. • Coordinate and plan activities for the user group along with the members and other stakeholders.

	• Coordinate and conduct meetings with members for development of the group. • Resolve conflict among group members. • Submit annual progress report to forest office. • Maintain record of all the group activities.
11.2 Secretary	Name of Secretary: Wangdi Contact No.17608080 <u>Responsibilities of Secretary:</u> • Obtain collection permit from forest office during the onset of harvesting season. • Officiate in absence of Chairperson. • Assist Chairperson in coordinating and planning group activities. • Explore market for NWFPs. • Maintain records of any activities conducted by the group. • Maintain attendance record while conducting meeting and group activities. • Record minutes of meeting.
11.3 Treasurer	Name of Treasurer: Dorji Pema Contact No.17243580 <u>Responsibilities of Treasurer:</u> • Officiate in absence of Chairperson and Secretary. • Collect annual membership fees, fines, amount from sale proceeds and deposit in the group account. • Maintain proper financial records in favor of the group. • Present financial status/ progress report during general meeting. • Assist Chairperson and Secretary in coordinating and planning group activities.
12. Tenure of committee member	• Their tenure shall be till the plan period ends. • However, if a committee member does not fulfill his/her responsibilities, misbehave and threaten the group's network, he/she shall be immediately replaced and be deprived of such opportunity in future.
13. Incentives to the committee members	• If the committee members have worked positively towards betterment of group, he/she shall be re-elected. This is to reward the individual for his/her dedicated service to the group.
14. Sources for generation of group fund	
14.1 Members hip registration fees. 14.2 Annual contribution 14.3 Collection from sale proceeds	• Membership fees of Nu.100 per member household shall be collected annually. • Nu.200 per member household shall be collected and deposited in the group account after marketing Pipla. • Amount realized as penalties shall be deposited in the group fund.

15. Group fund management and utilization	• A joint account in favor of the group shall be opened under BDBL, Buli. • Annual membership fees, fines and amount from sale proceeds shall be deposit in the group account. • The joint account will be managed by Executive Committee members. • Any expenditure incurred in the name of the group will be met from community development fund. • When the fund accumulates more than two hundred thousand, the fund will be utilized for community rituals, supporting the poor and disaster affected household. • If the group gets dissolved under unforeseen circumstances, all the fund accumulated shall be equally divided among the members.
16. Conflict resolution	• If any dispute arises within the group members, the matter shall be forwarded to Chairperson for settlement. If the case cannot be resolved, the matter shall be further forwarded to the Gewog Administration for final decision. • In case there is conflict between the NWFP group and outsiders, the case shall be forwarded to Divisional Forest Office, Zhemgang and Gewog Administration by the Chairperson.
17. Meeting and purpose	In order to plan and discuss activities for the management of NWFPs, meeting will be conducted as follows; • General Assembly: All the members shall attend the meeting to discuss and plan activities before harvesting season; during April month every year. • Committee member: This meeting is mainly to discuss the planned activities as well as prepare activities progress, financial and physical report (Nov)
18. Penalties	• If any of the members violate the harvesting rules, he/she shall be fined Nu.500 and will refrain from harvesting for rest of the season and subsequent season. • Absentees during work and meetings shall be fined Nu: 215/- per occasion. • Collection of NWFP during the off season shall be fined Nu.500 per person. • Marketing of NWFPs without notice of committee members, he/she shall be fined Nu.500 per occasion. • Committee members not performing their duties as required shall be fined Nu.500. • If group members do not obey the instruction of committee members, he/she shall be fined Nu.50 per person. • If any members sell NWFPs to outsider without prior notice of the group, he/she shall be fined Nu: 1500 per occasion. • If any outsider collects any NWFP products from designated area of the group, he/she shall be fined Nu. 1000 per occasion

Powers of the Department

The Department has the right to terminate the NWFP management and marketing group in case of any violation of the management plan prescription or in the event of inability to carry out the activities as per the plan.

Appendix I: Annual NWFP reporting form

Dzongkhag/Dungkhag:
Name of NWFP management and marketing group:
Gewog:
Villages:
Total number of Households:

NWFP Species	Quantity collected in a year	Qty sold in a year	Price received by the group per unit	Total income (Nu)	Description on resource availability	Remarks

Appendix II: List of NWFP Group members

Sl.No.	Name	House No.	Thram No.
1	Lemo	Wa-4-118	72
2	Yeshe Dorji	Wa-4-114	266
3	Pulungmo	Wa-4-119	106
4	Wangdi	Wa-4-117	75
5	Sangay Wangmo	Wa-4-120	516
6	Lhadenmo	Wa-4-113	70
7	Chekimo	Wa-4-340	348
8	Ugyen Dema	Wa-4-116	517
9	Dorji Pema	Wa-4-115	508
10	Sonam Choden	Wa-4-	